

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS - GENERAL MANAGEMENT

Fit with the Company

Note: Knowing as much about the company as possible is critical.

- Why this company?
- Why this industry?
- Why this location? (specifically for non-traditional locations)
- Are you flexible regarding location?
- What are you looking for in our company and program?
- What areas attract you in our company? Any specific business units/products that you specifically want to work for?
- What are the major challenges for the company? What can be improved?
- What do you know about our company's culture?
- What would you do to improve product XYZ?
- Where do you see the company going in the next five/10 years?
- What are the company growth engines?
What do you think our best product is? Our worst product?

Fit with General Management Role

- Why are you pursuing a GM role?
- What skills do you have that would make you a good general manager?
- What skills and experience can you bring to this role that differentiates you from other candidates?
- Have you had direct supervisory experience? If so, how would you describe your performance as a manager?
- What was your most significant leadership experience? (have examples from work & personal)
- Describe how you take initiative and get the job done
- How do you motivate others?
- What is your leadership or management style?

Behavioral

- Describe a team experience that did not work well. How did you handle it, and what did you learn?
- Give me an example of a teamwork experience you enjoyed. One that you didn't enjoy?
- Describe a situation where you had to work with ambiguity. How did you deal with the situation and what was the result?
- Describe a situation where you had to convince a team or manager about an idea.
- Your resume seems kind of qualitative. Give me an example of a time you worked on a quantitative project.
- Tell me about a time that you had to persuade someone to act when they were resistant.
- Tell me about a time when you had to make a decision, but didn't have all the information you felt you needed to make that decision.
- Tell me about a time when you had a disagreement with your manager? How did you handle the situation?

- Tell me about a time when you gave feedback? What is your style for giving feedbacks for others?
- Tell me about a time when you received a negative feedback? How did you react?
- Tell me about a time when you had to deliver bad news to someone.
- Tell me about a time when you worked on a cross-functional project or team.
- Tell me about a time when you failed and what you have learned from it.
- What are three of your strengths? Three weaknesses?
- Describe an ethical dilemma you faced.
- Describe a time you took a risk and failed.
- Tell me about a time when you led a team or a project.
- Tell me about a time when you executed a plan.

Specific Skills (Finance / Strategy / Negotiation)

- Describe a situation where you had to develop a strategic plan—walk me through, at a high level, some of your thinking.
- Please describe any experience you have with negotiation of financial transactions or with negotiation in general.
- How would you evaluate a project that our company is planning to invest in? What kind of risks would you evaluate and how would you evaluate them?
- Tell me about a time you had to convince someone of something using data.
- Depending on the company some ask technical questions (NPV, accounting, valuation, etc.). These types of questions are mainly asked in 2nd rounds of interviews.

Career

- Why did you decide to leave your previous career?
- Why are you choosing to join a company and not investment bank or consulting firm?
- Where do you see yourself in five and 10 years?
- Will you relocate? Are you willing to travel or work internationally?

Additional General Questions

- How would your friends and family describe you?
- What was the most challenging or riskiest decision you have made?
- Why have you succeeded in the past?
- Tell me about some of your outside interests.
- What do you do for fun?

Case Type Questions

These questions vary widely from company to company. The interviewer will most likely be looking for you to see the big picture and come up with a common sense answer with a logical and supported argument. (Example case question: My friend has an idea for a business, XYZ. Do you think I should go into business with him?).

(*) Please read this document together with additional interview prep guides. While it includes a lot of questions it is certainly not a close list.